

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1562

By Wright

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Steve Hunley for his many contributions to Knox County and the State of Tennessee.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should specially recognize those estimable individuals who have distinguished themselves as dedicated professionals through their commitment to their communities; and

WHEREAS, one such outstanding person is Steve Hunley, who has compiled a distinguished record of achievement in business, education, and public service in Knox County and East Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, the son of William Kenneth Hunley, Sr., and Priscilla Clodell Brewer Hunley, Steve Hunley was born in 1951 and graduated from Central High School in 1969; and

WHEREAS, on June 9, 1972, he married the love of his life, Kimberly Blair Hunley; and

WHEREAS, in 1975, Mr. Hunley graduated with honors from the University of Tennessee, Knoxville, with a concentration in business, becoming the first in his family to earn a college degree; and

WHEREAS, Steve Hunley later built a successful career in business, working with Merck Pharmaceuticals Calgon Division and Kendall Motor Oil before co-founding Superior Cleaners with his brother Con Hunley and Earl Glandon, and the business grew to five locations; and

WHEREAS, in 1986, he founded Superior Petroleum Marketers, serving major clients and further establishing his reputation as a successful entrepreneur; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Hunley has long demonstrated a commitment to his community through his support of youth athletics, contributing his time and resources to the Gibbs Youth Athletic Association and the construction and improvement of athletic facilities in the Gibbs community, including the Gibbs High School baseball field, Gibbs softball facilities, and contributions to the

Gibbs football stadium and field house; and

WHEREAS, he has also played an important role in the development of educational infrastructure in the Gibbs community, supporting the Gibbs Elementary School project in 2007, the Carter Middle School project completed in 2013, and the dedication of Gibbs Middle School on August 8, 2018; and

WHEREAS, Steve Hunley served with distinction as a member of the Knox County Board of Education from 1996 to 2000; and

WHEREAS, in response to the closure of the middle school in the Gibbs community in 1991, Mr. Hunley founded *The Knoxville Focus* in 2002 and, through his persistence and dedication, contributed to the eventual return of a middle school to the Gibbs community; and

WHEREAS, he has been active in civic and political life as a member and chairman of the 8th District Republican Club and founding member of the Three Rivers Republican Club and has served as a political consultant, contributing to numerous campaigns in the region, including the mayoral campaign of Tim Burchett; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Hunley continues to serve as publisher and columnist for *The Knoxville Focus* and remains active in local business, political, and charitable endeavors; and

WHEREAS, his many accomplishments aside, Mr. Hunley is most appreciative of the love and support he shares with his wife, Kim, and their two children, Nikki and Stephen; and

WHEREAS, Steve Hunley is the brother of country music artist Con Hunley, as well as Tim, Kenny, Beth, and Ruth, a musically endowed family with fond memories of performing at the Corner Bar and the Village Barn, which led to the founding of IMMI records; and

WHEREAS, a public-spirited citizen of the highest order, Mr. Hunley has compiled a singular record of success during his exemplary career; and

WHEREAS, his remarkable success is directly attributable to his reliance on the time-honored values of hard work and common sense and his uncommon ability to work well with

people from all walks of life; and

WHEREAS, throughout his life, Steve Hunley has exemplified the values of hard work, family devotion, community service, educational advocacy, and civic engagement that strengthen the fabric of this State; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Steve Hunley for his many contributions to Knox County and the State of Tennessee and extend to him our best wishes for continued success and happiness in the years ahead.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.